SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL

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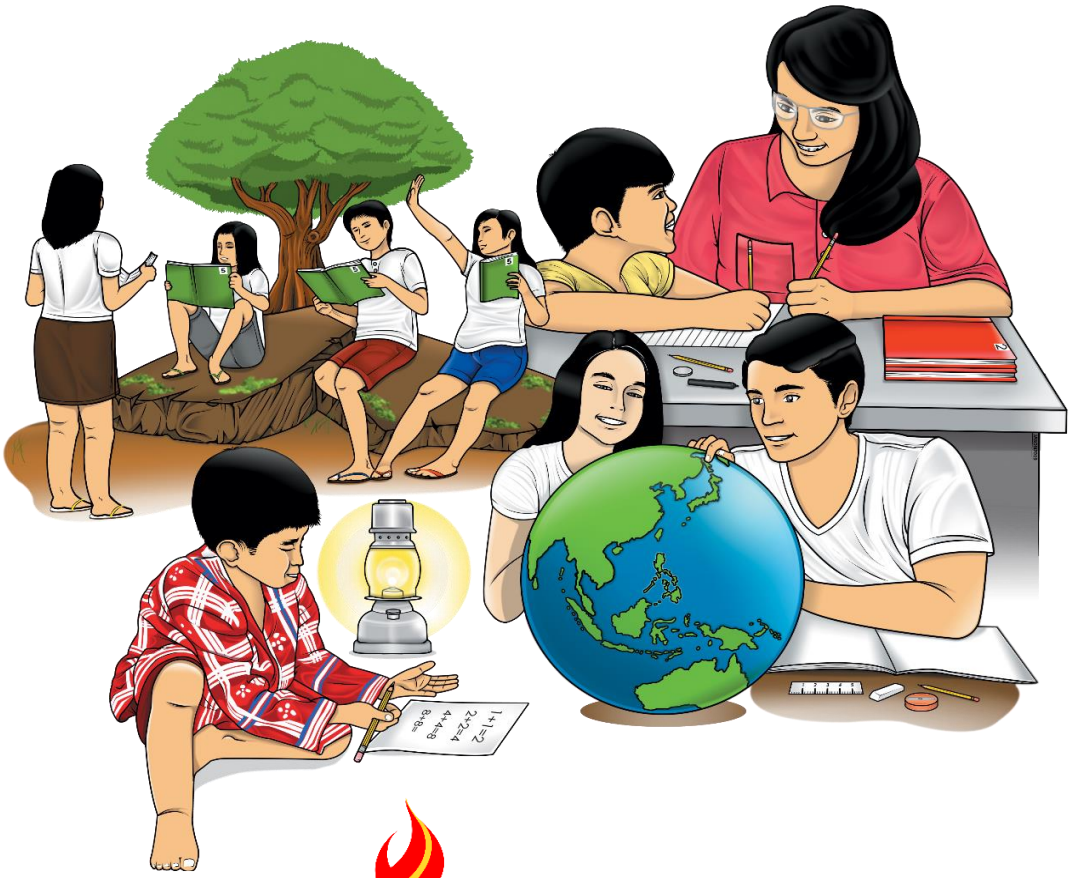
Introduction to World Religions & Belief Systems

Quarter 2
Module 2



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SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL

Introduction to World Religions and Belief Systems

(Second QUARTER)
(MODULE NUMBER 2)

DepED
DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION

Introductory Message

For the facilitator:

Welcome to the Introduction to World Religions and Belief Systems Grade 11 Alternative Delivery Mode (ADM) Module on week 9-15!

This module was collaboratively designed, developed and reviewed by educators both from public and private institutions to assist you, the teacher or facilitator in helping the learners meet the standards set by the K to 12 Curriculum while overcoming their personal, social, and economic constraints in schooling.

This learning resource hopes to engage the learners into guided and independent learning activities at their own pace and time. Furthermore, this also aims to help learners acquire the needed 21st century skills while taking into consideration their needs and circumstances.

In addition to the material in the main text, you will also see this box in the body of the module:

Notes to the Teacher

This contains helpful tips or strategies that will help you in guiding the learners.

As a facilitator you are expected to orient the learners on how to use this module. You also need to keep track of the learners' progress while allowing them to manage their own learning. Furthermore, you are expected to encourage and assist the learners as they do the tasks included in the module.

What I Need to Know

Different religions can be traced in Asia. One of which is the Theravada Buddhism which has become an integral part of world religions. Over the centuries it gained significant followers and gave birth to Mahayana Buddhism whose influence can be felt across the globe. As a student of this course, this module will help the learners analyze the brief history, core teachings, fundamental beliefs, practices, and related issues of Theravada Buddhism (MELC).

What I know

Directions: Read each question carefully and encircle the correct answer.

1. Theravada has been the predominant religion of continental Southeast Asia. This includes Thailand, Myanmar/Burma, Cambodia, and _____
   A. Philippines
   B. Laos
   C. Singapore
   D. Malaysia

2. Theravada is the school of Buddhism that draws its scriptural inspiration from the Tipitaka, or Pali canon. Theravada means_____
   A. Doctrine of the Elder Monks
   B. Followers of Buddha
   C. The Enlightened One
   D. The Four Noble Truths

3. Buddhist followers are mostly found in the Asian continent, which Asian country has the highest Buddhist majority in terms of population
   A. Cambodia
   B. Thailand
   C. Bhutan
   C. Laos

4. Buddha means_____
   A. The Enlightened One
   B. The Chosen One
   C. The Messiah
   D. The God

5. Which of the following is NOT part of the four encounters?_____
   A. Meeting an old man
   B. Seeing crippled man
   C. Decaying corpse
   D. Great Enlightenment

Lesson 9 Theravada Buddhism

Buddhism is one of the most practical among the world's great religions because its belief system intends to meet basic human needs and solve humankind's spiritual problem without depending on supernatural forces (Brown 1975). The two main divisions of the religion are Mahayana Buddhism and Theravada Buddhism. With around 360 million followers, Mahayana Buddhism is practiced in China, Japan, and Mongolia. Meanwhile, Theravada Buddhism, with 150 million adherents, is followed in Myanmar, Thailand, and Sri Lanka.

Buddhism is the religion of around 500 million people or about 7% to 8% of the world's population. Buddhist followers are mostly found in the Asian continent, with China having the largest population at around 244 million or 18% of its total population. Asian countries that have the highest Buddhist majority in terms of population include Cambodia (97%), Thailand (93%), Myanmar (80%), Bhutan (75%), Sri Lanka (69%), and Laos (66%). Buddhism has two main divisions and many sects.

A major branch of the religion, Theravada Buddhism ("school of elder monks" or "school of the ancients") or the "Southern School of Buddhism" draws on the collected teachings of the oldest recorded texts of Buddhist texts to become its central precept, the Pali Canon. This school claims to have preserved the original teachings of Siddhartha with pristine purity (Clasper 1992). Theravada Buddhism has gained considerable following in the West in modern times

What's New

Life of the Buddha

The sage Siddhartha Gautama may have been born between 563 B.C.E. to 480 B.C.E. into the Sakya tribe in Lumbini (in present-day Nepal) in the foothills of the Nepalese Himalayas (Kulananda 2001). Born into the Kshatriya caste, his father was Suddhodana, an aristocratic Hindu chieftain, and his mother was Mahamaya, a Koliyan princess. The Buddha's family name was Gautama or Gotama.

The word "Buddha" means "the awakened one" or the "enlightened one." At the time of his birth, the seer Asita predicted that the child was destined for either political or spiritual ascendancy (Skilton 1994; Kulananda 2001). He was given noble education and instruction in science, horsemanship, and archery (Toula-Breysse 2001). At the age of sixteen, Suddhodana arranged Siddhartha's marriage to a beautiful and refined young woman, Yasodhara (also Siddhartha's cousin), who later gave birth to their son Rahula. Siddhartha spent 29 years as a prince in Kapilavastu and he began to develop a keen sense of discontent. As he felt constant emptiness despite living a life of luxury and ease, he sought answers to his questions by leaving his comfortable abode without the knowledge or approval of his family. He left his wife, child, and social status as he began to search for truth and liberation (Kulananda 2001). Siddhartha's venture outside the comfort of the palace led him to encounter four suffering people that eventually transformed his outlook on life

(Brown 1975). The four encounters or the "Four Signs" that occurred made him realize the inevitability of misery in people's lives. First, meeting an old man made him accept that old age was an unavoidable circumstance no matter how unwelcome it is to a person. Second, a crippled man reflected upon him that illness is inescapable despite a person's relentless effort to avoid any disease. Third, a decaying corpse made him understand that death was the inevitable end of all. Last, an ascetic monk or *shramana* impressed upon him the person's tranquility and the possibility of renouncing worldly pleasures in exchange for utter quietude. All these distressing manifestations convinced him that worldly and material possessions could not satisfy one's need. Siddhartha practiced asceticism in search of a way to escape suffering. Far withdrawn from his accustomed environment, he lived at the outskirts of society and associated himself with religious masters. Seated beneath a pipal tree, now known as the bo or bodhi tree, near the Indian village of Bodh Gaya in Bihar, Siddhartha finally obtained his enlightenment after years of searching as he passed the four stages of meditative trance or *dhyana/jhana*. After 49 days of meditation, Siddhartha emerged victorious and attained the state of absolute awakening. He became a "Buddha" or the "awakened one" whose every action from thereon would be motivated only by generosity, compassion, and wisdom (Toula-Breysse 2001). He had visions of the endless cycle of birth and death that was the fate of humankind (Hopfe 1983).

Siddhartha was 35 years old when he attained enlightenment. Walking more than a hundred miles to Sarnath near the ancient city of Varanasi, he met his former disciples whom he was able to convince about the truth of his teachings. Siddhartha preached throughout the regions of India, such as Magadha and Kosala.

For 45 years, he travelled northern India to the cities and towns of the central Ganges basin and preached a message of hope and happiness while winning many new converts to his fold (Brown 1975; Skilton 1994). Siddhartha lived and preached during the reign of Bimbisara, the ruler of the Magadha Empire from 542 B.C.E. to 492 B.C.E. With only about two hours of sleep at night, he scarcely had any rest in his mission to propagate his teachings to the people. At age 80 and on a full moon, Siddhartha died in Kushinagar between 483 B.C.E. to 400 B.C.E. during the early years of Ajasatru (Bimbisara's successor) who ruled around 492 B.C.E. to 460 B.C.E

Activity 1. Siddharta's Life Journey

Directions: Rearrange Siddharta's life by indicating the numbers **1-5** on the space provided.

_____ A. At the age of sixteen, Suddhodana arranged Siddhartha's marriage to a beautiful and refined young woman, Yasodhara

_____ B. The sage Siddhartha Gautama may have been born between 563 B.C.E. to 480 B.C.E. into the Sakya tribe in Lumbini (in present-day Nepal) near the town of Kapilavastu (the capital city of the Sakya state)

_____ C. At age 80 and on a full moon, Siddhartha died in Kushinagar between 483 B.C.E. to 400 B.C.E. during the early years of Ajasatru

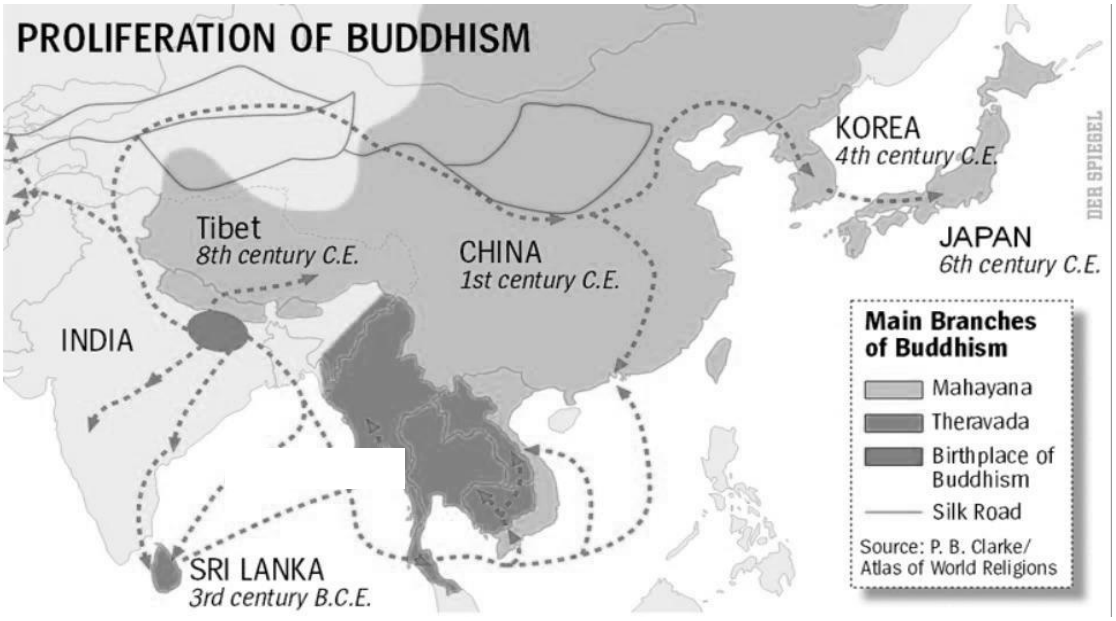
_____ D. He lived as an ascetic with homeless existence (Bowker 1997). For the next six years, he practiced religious strictness, wore no clothes, and did not wash.

_____ E. Seated beneath a pipal tree, now known as the bo or bodhi tree, near the Indian village of Bodh Gaya in Bihar, Siddhartha finally obtained his enlightenment.

Mapping the Roots

Theravada Buddhism can be traced all the way back to the First Council, shortly after Buddha's death. Theravada Buddhists claim that they have adhered to the Buddha's original teachings and are, therefore, the purest form of Buddhism. They established the Pali Canon, the teachings that were passed down orally for 400 years. The Theravada (Doctrine of Elders) is the sole surviving school of Buddhism from the early days of Buddhism. It traces its roots back to the Buddha himself and his closest disciples. It is also known as Southern Buddhism because this is where it has flourished over the centuries: Sri Lanka, Thailand, Burma, Cambodia, and Laos. Theravada keeps its ties close to the life of the Buddha and the Pali Canon (unlike Mahayana that has introduced new texts and concepts). Today Theravada Buddhists number well over 100 million worldwide. In recent decades Theravada has begun to take root in the West.

Activity 2: Mapping the Roots
Directions: Using the map below. Identify the countries where Theravada Buddhism proliferated.



http://wiki.sjs.org/wiki/index.php/Main_branches_of_Buddhism

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

The Language of Theravada

The language of the Theravada canonical texts is Pali, which is based on a dialect of Middle Indo-Aryan that was probably spoken in central India during the Buddha's time. Ven Ananda, the Buddha's cousin and close personal attendant

committed the Buddha's sermons *(suttas)* to memory and thus became a living repository of these teachings.

In Pali language, the word *pitaka* translates as "basket" referring to the receptacles where the palm leaf manuscripts were stored by the monks. The table summarizes the three baskets.

Table 1. The *Tripitaka*

***Tripitaka* (Basket)**	**Contents**
Sutta Pitaka (Discourse)	Buddha's doctrinal discourses; short poems to long prose narratives about Siddhartha's previous lives *Vinaya Pitaka* (Discipline)
Vinaya Pitaka (Discipline)	Rules of discipline; stories that illustrate Buddhist moral principles
Abhidhamma Pitaka (Ultimate Doctrine)	Systematic analysis of the categories of Buddhist thought

What is It

Who was the Buddha?

Despite Buddhism's regional diversity, the primary figure of all Buddhist practice is the Buddha himself. Siddhartha Gautama was an Indian prince who, in his twenties, chose to renounce his aristocratic life of luxury and seek enlightenment. After a period of severe self-denial, he developed a more moderate approach, realizing that neither indulgence nor denial could be effective in realizing his goals: this philosophy of moderation is sometimes referred to as the Middle Path. He journeyed to a place called Bodh Gaya in northeast India and meditated under a large tree that came to be known as the Bodhi Tree or the "tree of awakening." Despite temptations and assaults by personifications of worldliness and desire, Siddhartha became aware of the Dharma (Truth or Law) of human existence: it was the beginning of his enlightenment.

Each religion has its own unique way of meditation or prayer. Just like Siddhartha Gautama, he meditated and found enlightenment. As a student, how do you meditate or pray? What do you pray or meditate for? How does meditation/prayer give you enlightenment?

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

What's More

Within the fourth noble truth is found the guide to the end of suffering: the noble eightfold path. The eight parts of the path to liberation are grouped into three essential elements of Buddhist practice—moral conduct, mental discipline, and

wisdom. The Buddha taught the eightfold path in virtually all his discourses, and his directions are as clear and practical to his followers today as they were when he first gave them.

A. Directions: Enumerate the Eightfold Paths?

1. right _____
2. right _____
3. right _____
4. right _____
5. right _____
6. right _____
7. right _____
8. right _____

B. Directions: Complete the table by filling in the blanks with the correct answer. Choose the answer from the list below.

untruthfulness tale-bearing single overcome living thing

killing Four Noble Truths feeling maintain

Eightfold Path What One Must Do

Right View, Understand the "_____ "(1)
Right Intention
Free oneself from ill-will, cruelty, and_____(2)
Right Speech
Abstain from untruthfulness, _____, (3) harsh language, and vain talk
Right Action
Abstain from_____, (4) stealing, and sexual misconduct
Right Livelihood
Earn a living in a way not harmful to any _____ (5)
Right Effort
Avoid evil thoughts_____ and (6) them, arouse good thoughts and_____ (7) them
Right Mindfulness
Pay vigilant attention to every state of the body, _____, (8) and mind
Right Concentration
Concentrate on a_____ (9) object so as to induce certain special states of consciousness in deep meditation

What I can Do

Meditation

Directions: Meditate for 5 minutes. This meditation exercise is an excellent introduction to meditation techniques. Follow the simple steps and answer the questions below.

A) Sit or lie comfortably.

B) Close your eyes.
C) Make no effort to control the breath; simply breathe naturally.
D) Focus your attention on the breath and on how the body moves with each inhalation and exhalation.
E) Maintain this meditation practice for two to three minutes to start, and then try it for longer periods.

Guide Questions:

1. Describe your experience_____
2. How does meditation help people to achieve "Enlightenment? _____
3. Is meditation the same as prayer? Why or why not? _____
4. Medical experts say there are health benefits of meditation. Cite some of its benefits_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

What I Need to Know

Believing itself as the more genuine version of Buddha's teachings, Mahayana Buddhism has diverged into numerous schools with each developing its own canon and rituals since its founding more than two thousand years ago. Also known as the "Great Vehicle," Mahayana Buddhism emerged out of monastic rule and doctrinal differences within the original form of Buddhism.

This module will help the learners analyze the brief history, core teachings, fundamental beliefs, practices, and related issues of Theravada Buddhism and Mahayana Buddhism (MELC).

What I know

Directions: Read each question carefully then encircle the correct answer.

1. The term Mahayana is a Sanskrit word which literally means _____
   A.Great Vehicle B. Great Monk C. Great Teachings D. Great Enlightenment
2. It is one of the early Buddhist schools, is said to be the source of early growth of Mahayana Buddhism
   A. The *Mahasamghika* B. *Tipitaka* C. the Sanskrit D. *Soka Gakkai*
3. It possesses innumerable figures often lacking in the Theravada literature, including the *bodhisattvas*, demons, divinities, and other spirits.
   A. Theravada B. Mahayana C. Rig Veda D. Jainism

4. The canon of Mahayana Buddhism also consists of the Tripitaka, namely, *Sutra Pitaka* (Discourse), *Vinaya Pitaka* (Discipline), and _____
   A. bodhisattva ("enlightened existence")
   B. Abhidharma Pitaka (Ultimate Doctrine).
   C. Jodo Shin-shu ("True Pure Land School")
   D. Sukhavati ("Pure Land of the West")
5. Which language was adopted by the Mahayana Buddhims?
   A. Hindi B. Indo-aryan C. Pali D. Sanskrit

Lesson 10 Mahayana Buddhism

Mahayana is an umbrella term which describes several different schools, the earliest of which emerged between the 1st century BCE and the 1st century CE. Mahayana is seen by modern scholars as a new movement which developed its own vast collection of scriptures between the first and fifth centuries CE, which include different interpretations of the Buddha's teachings. Mahayana also developed different forms of worship to Theravada Buddhism. Mahayana gave rise to two main philosophical schools of Buddhism – *Madhyamaka* and *Chittamatra*. Over the years Mahayana spread to other countries and other schools of Buddhism developed from it such as Zen and Pure Land, popular in Japan and China.

After about 500 years Buddhism spread to China, Korea, and Japan. In these countries people were usually encouraged to marry and work to support themselves and their families. For these reasons there are fewer monks and nuns in countries. The main Buddhist tradition practiced in these areas is Mahayana Buddhism. The name means '**Greater Vehicle**' which suggests that it aims to help many people move along the Buddhist path, whether they are monastic or lay Buddhists. There are different types of Mahayana Buddhism including Zen and Pure Land Buddhism, both popular in Japan.

The new developments within the newfound Buddhist sect comprise a set of differing notions pertaining to the original founder and great teacher Siddhartha Gautama himself.

Firstly, Mahayana Buddhists believed that Siddhartha secretly taught key principles to chosen people, to his most dedicated disciples, or to the most faithful who could completely interpret these teachings in time (Hopfe 1983; Losch 2001). Simply put, any new teaching can now be added to the emerging Buddhist faith.

Secondly, Mahayana Buddhists forwarded the concept that Siddhartha Gautama was a benevolent celestial being, not just a mere human being. Because of his love for humankind and zeal to help the people, he came to our world in human form.

Thirdly, Mahayana Buddhists advanced the radical idea that Siddhartha Gautama was not the only Buddha. There were other divine beings that came to our world even before Siddhartha, some of them came after him, and still others will come. Principally, these beings came to earth to help lessen people's sufferings and lead them to salvation. This unique concept impressed many followers because they can now revere these beings, study their lives, construct temples, and develop an innovative belief system replete with rituals and hymns, among others (Hopfe 1983).

What's New

The concept of *trikaya* ("three bodies") pertains to the teaching of Mahayana Buddhism about the nature of the Buddha and reality. This doctrine is very well-mentioned in Mahayana Buddhism which states that each Buddha has three bodies, namely, dharmakaya, sambhogakaya, and nirmanakaya. Study the table below which summarizes the nature of the three bodies of Buddha.

Table 2.1 Three Bodies of Buddha

The Body	Nature or Aspect of "Buddhahood"	Manifestations
Dharmakaya	Body of absolute truth; absolute nature of all beings	Buddha is transcendent
Sambhogakaya	Body that experiences bliss of enlightenment	Buddha's body of bliss, or enjoyment body
Nirmanakaya	Body that manifests the world; embodiment of dharmakaya in human form	Buddha's earthly body, just like any other human being's body

Activity 1: Define Me
Directions: Briefly explain the following terms:

1. **Bodhisattva**_____
2. **Nirvana**_____
3. **Self-liberation**_____
4. **Polytheistic belief**_____
5. **Triyaka**_____

The missionaries of Mahayana Buddhism were able to penetrate new places without fear of reprisal from native religions since deities or local gods can be treated as manifestations or incarnations of Buddha. Other religions could be absorbed by Mahayana Buddhism by way of this key principle in their proselytizing activities. While Theravada was the first to enter China during the first century C.E., Buddhism did not gain much ground here not until the arrival of Mahayana in the third century C.E. In time, Mahayana Buddhism took a major foothold of China while local beliefs were relegated to lesser stature (Hopfe 1983). Korea was the next territory to be influenced by Mahayana school around the fourth century C.E. and followed by Japan in the sixth century C.E.

Mahayana Buddhism existed alongside Japan's native religion Shintoism. Mongolia and Tibet likewise embraced Mahayana Buddhism. All these places developed their own versions of Mahayana Buddhism that exist up until the present day.

Reasons why Mahayana disappeared in India:

1. A series of invasions destroyed numerous Buddhist centers and temples. The rising tide of Islam in India resulted in the forcible conversion of Buddhists to the Muslim faith.

2. Hinduism was able to gradually absorb challenging religions, such as Buddhism and Jainism, due to its tolerance and openness to other belief systems.
3. The Hindu belief that Siddhartha Gautama was a manifestation of Vishnu contributed to the fading influence of Buddhism in India. Mahayana Buddhism disappeared in India during the eleventh century.

Bhumis and Paramitas

Based on the Mahayana tradition, a bodhisattva must pass 10 *Bhumis* ("grounds" of "land") before attaining the so-called "Buddha-hood." These are extensions of the "Eightfold Path" as discussed in the previous lesson on Theravada Buddhism. The *Bhumis* are frequently associated with the paramitas ("perfections"). Translated as "to cross over the other shore," paramitas imply crossing from the "sea of suffering" to the "shore of happiness." One is lifted from the cycle of rebirth to finally achieve liberation. While the first five paramitas are principally concerned with the accumulation of merits, the sixth paramita involves the attainment of wisdom.

Activity 2: The Paramitas

All Buddhists follow the Eightfold-Path; however, Mahayana Buddhists also follow the Bodhisattva Path which is divided into ten stages (*Bhumis,* literally meaning 'grounds'). Enumerate the six perfections (*paramitas*).

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

What is It

Sacred Texts and Scriptures

The Mahayana branch accepts the canonical texts of the Theravada school, such as the Tripitaka (Sanskrit word for "Three Baskets") The canon of Mahayana Buddhism also consists of the *Tripitaka*, namely, *Sutra Pitaka* (Discourse), *Vinaya Pitaka* (Discipline), and *Abhidharma Pitaka* (Ultimate Doctrine). As the original language of transmission, Mahayana Buddhism adopted the Sanskrit rather than the Pali form of common terms strictly used in Theravada Buddhism, such as sutra (or sutta in Pali) and dharma (or dhamma in Pali). The Mahayana school possesses innumerable figures often lacking in the Theravada literature, including the bodhisattvas, demons, divinities, and other spirits. One of the most popular and prominent Mahayana Buddhist texts (or sutra) is the Lotus Sutra, or the *Saddharmapundarika*-sutra that literally means "correct dharma white lotus sutra" or "Sutra of the Lotus of the Wonderful Law" in Sanskrit. A key idea within the influential sutra is that all people equally and inherently possess the so-called

“Buddha nature” or “Buddhahood” which is the condition of complete happiness and freedom from fear and illusions. In short, the attainment of enlightenment is open to all people regardless of gender, race, social status, and education.

What’s More

Mahayana view of the Buddha.

From the Mahayana perspective Buddha was already enlightened when he was born as Siddhartha Gautama. His decision to take a physical form was a voluntary one. Whereas Theravada Buddhism see the Buddha as a historical figure, Mahayana Buddhists believe that Buddha remains active and can influence the world. He can be encountered through meditation and even visions. He can manifest himself in many different forms, times, and places.

Mahayana Buddhists aim to gain Buddhahood, to become a Buddha – an enlightened being. They believe everyone can do this because everyone has an inherent Buddha-nature. As a Senior High School student, how do you think you can achieve enlightenment?

_____
_____
_____
_____

Sunyata.

An important concept in Mahayana Buddhism is sunyata, which is often translated as ‘emptiness’. For Mahayana Buddhists, understanding sunyata is essential for achieving enlightenment. Sunyata could be understood to be a restatement of anatta. It emphasizes that not only do human beings not have a fixed, independent, unchanging nature, but in fact all things are like that. Nothing exists independently but only in relation to and because of, other things. A wave, for example cannot be separated from the sea. In the Mahayana Six Perfections (paramitas), the sixth perfection is prajna paramita -- the perfection of wisdom. It is said of the perfection of wisdom that it contains all the other perfections, and without it no perfection is possible. "Wisdom," in this case, is nothing other than the realization of sunyata. This realization is said to be the door to enlightenment.

"Realization" is emphasized because an intellectual understanding of a doctrine of emptiness is not the same thing as wisdom. To be wisdom, emptiness first must be intimately and directly perceived and experienced. Even so, an intellectual understanding of sunyata is the usual first step to realization.

Activity 2: The Sunyata

Directions: List down 5 things you realized in life that gave you wisdom.

1. _____
2. _____

3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

What I can Do

Bodhisattvas

One distinct feature of Mahayana Buddhism concerns its teaching about an enlightened being or *bodhisattva* ("enlightened existence") which is the ultimate way for any Buddhist to live in this world. A *bodhisattva* has generated bodhicitta or the spontaneous desire to achieve the state of being enlightened. The concept of bodhicitta greatly differs between the two main schools of Buddhism. The teachings of Theravada place a great emphasis on self-liberation where there is a total reliance on oneself to eradicate sufferings. On the other hand, apart from self-liberation, it is also essential for Mahayana adherents to assist other sentient beings in their quest for liberation. The attainment of nirvana is not confined to oneself as an arhat ("perfected one") but must be shared to all striving beings (Bowker 1997).

Based on Bodhisattvas, how can a person can attain "nirvana"?

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

What I Need to Know

In Hinduism and Buddhism (Mahayana and Theravada), dharma is an important concept. In Hinduism, dharma refers to the religious and moral law governing a person's conduct. It is also one of the four Hindu goals of life. For the two Buddhist schools, it may pertain to the cosmic law and order or to Buddha's teachings. Apart from the Buddha and the sangha, the dharma is one of the "Three Jewels" to which Buddhist followers go for refuge. Hindu followers comprise 80% of India's population of more than a billion or about 14% of the world's population. Meanwhile, there are more than 370 million Buddhists around the world that represent about 6% of the entire population. Buddhism began in India, but it almost died out as a living religion in its place of origin (Coogan 2005). Majority of its

followers can be found in China Japan, Korea, and Indochina Peninsula. The major sects of Buddhism include Theravada and Mahayana schools of thought.

The Most Essential Learning Competency for this lesson is to explain the uniqueness and similarities of Mahayana and Theravada Buddhism. Further, the learners can:

- Make a comparative analysis on Theravada and Mahayana Buddhism.
- Identify the similarities and differences of Theravada and Mahayana Buddhism.
- Trace the countries where Mahayana and Theravada Buddhism flourished.

What I know

Directions: Identify whether the following concepts describe **Mahayana** or **Theravada.**

_____ 1. The monastic way of life ensures the path toward enlightenment.
_____ 2. Laity must first be reborn as monks for them to be eligible for enlightenment.
_____ 3. It offers enlightenment to anyone, not only for the members of the monastic order, but also for those with families and secular careers.
_____ 4. It attracts followers because it offers a faster route to enlightenment.
_____ 5. A person who has attained this position is called an arhat or a "worthy person".

Lesson 11 Comparative Analysis on Mahayana Buddhism and Theravada Buddhism

Origin

Both Hinduism and Buddhism trace their origin in India. Buddhism is an interpretation of the Hindu belief. This religion is closely linked to its founder Siddhartha Gautama who is also referred to as the Buddha or the "Enlightened One". About 500 years after Buddha's enlightenment, a schism within the Buddhist religion resulted in the emergence of two major branches around the first century C.E, namely, the Theravada and Mahayana schools of tradition. Both schools owe their fundamental teachings to the Buddha.

The destiny of all Hindus involves reincarnation. Hindu practices to achieve enlightenment involves yoga, meditation, proper worship, rituals, devotion to gods and goddesses, pilgrimage to sacred shrines, and performing one's duties. Meanwhile, Buddhism holds that no soul is being reborn because there is no permanence in anything (Bowker 1997). Buddhist destiny is the direct result of natural law or dharma and one's accumulated deeds or karma. The Theravada school of Buddhism, the trainings on the development of ethical conduct, meditation, and insight assist in eradicating all forms of evil to acquire goodness and purify the mind. All worldly things are momentary and impermanent by following the "Middle Path" and practicing the basic doctrines of Buddhism, there is a realization that desire can be terminated and suffering reduced. In the end, a perfected state of insight can be accomplished. A person who has attained this position is called an arhat or a "worthy

person" who must be emulated by Theravada Buddhists. Adherents can reach an enlightened status through their own ways without any assistance from any divine beings, such as gods or goddesses. Meanwhile, the Mahayana sect devotes much attention to the bodhisattvas or "enlightened beings" who delay their own enlightenment for them to benevolently aid other beings to reach their ultimate end. All beings can follow the path of the bodhisattvas which is the ideal way for all Buddhists to live.

What's New

Reincarnation

Reincarnation is the transmigration of the soul from one life form to another. It doesn't just apply to humans but to all creatures and some non-living things too. Transmigration of the soul can take place from a human or creature into another human or creature up or down a scale based on good and evil deeds. If a person has lived a virtuous life, he moves up the scale, say, from a low caste to a high caste. If a person has lived an unworthy life, he moves down the scale, say, from a low caste to a rat.

Reincarnation is a belief found in most Asian religions and is a cornerstone of all the major religions found in India except Islam. Through constant rebirths, Buddhists believe they can escape the Wheel of Life and ascend to nirvana. In Theravada Buddhism a person can be reborn in one of three level of existence: 1) the world, 2) the hells below, and 3) the heavens above.

Buddhists believe in "karmic energy" rather than souls. Followers respond to life in their own self-interest rather than out of allegiance to a god or creator. Since only humans can break out of the cycle of reincarnation, human life is seen as opportunity that must seized upon to improve one's fate and effort towards transcendence. The Hindu idea of reincarnation is roughly the same regardless of which Hindu god an individual venerates most.

Karma

The doctrine of karma holds that, through the working of a just, automatic, and impersonal cosmic law, one's actions in this incarnation and in all previous ones will determine which position in the hierarchy of living things one will occupy in the next incarnation. An individual's karma can be improved through certain acts and omissions. By following the five precepts or commandments, a Buddhist can better his or her karma. These commandments are do not kill, do not steal, do not indulge in forbidden sexual pleasures, do not tell lies, and do not take intoxicants or stupefying drugs or liquors.

The most effective way to work actively to improve one's karma is to earn merit. Any act of benevolence or generosity can gain merit for the doer. Theravada Buddhists tend to regard opportunities for earning merit as primarily connected with interaction with the sangha (monks), contributing to its support through money, goods, and labor, and participating in its activities.

Karma is the means in which a person controls his or her destiny through good or evil deeds. Defined by some scholars as “the whole ethical consequences of one's actions," it is a moral force that survives death, determines one's existence in future lives and has defined existence in past lives.

Karma is a Sanskrit word that means "work" or "action” and the “result of a work or action." It describes a "reap what you sow" and the “cause and effect” doctrine in which good actions will be rewarded and bad actions will be punished on both universal and individual levels and influence one's reincarnation. The emphasis in karma beliefs is not based on punishment for bad deeds but rather on improving one's karma by learning from one's mistakes and performing pure deeds, praying, mediating, and taking actions to purify oneself.

Activity 1. Let’s Be Insightful

Directions: Briefly explain the following:

1. Do you believe in karma? Why or why not?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
2. Karma is described as “you reap what you sow”. Cite one instance in which you experience karma, good or bad. How do you feel about it?
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____
   _____

Activity 2: Comparing Concepts
Directions: Compare Mahayana Buddhism from Theravada Buddhism by completing the table. Choose your answer from the box below.

• bodhisattvas or “enlightened • Nirvana
• offers enlightenment to anyone, not only for the members of the monastic order, but also for those with families and secular careers the monastic way of life ensures the path toward enlightenment
• Karma • Four Noble Truths • Eightfold paths
• China Myanmar Tibet • Mongolia Thailand

- Korea Sri Lanka
- Japan India

	Mahayana	**Theravada**
Origin		
Destiny		
Purpose		
Morality		
Countries		

What is It

In Hinduism, there are four desirable goals of life (*purushartha*). All Hindus aim to achieve the four-fold purpose of life that includes*: Dharma* means to behave appropriately and act righteously; *Artha* pertains to the pursuit of legitimate worldly prosperity or material well-being; *Kama* refers to the pursuit of legitimate pleasure as one obtains enjoyment in life, such as those related to arts, music, and dance; *Moksha* is the final meaning of life that involves enlightenment, self-realization, or union with god. The main purpose of their life is to obtain release from the cycle of reincarnation or at least a better rebirth. In Buddhism, the principal purpose of one's life is to terminate all forms of suffering caused by attachment to impermanent entities, such as material things, friends, and health. All these do not offer enduring happiness but sorrow. Buddha's teachings on the "Four Noble Truths" and the "Noble Eightfold Path" form the basic tenets of all Buddhist sects. In Theravada Buddhism, the monastic way of life ensures the path toward enlightenment. For the Buddhist laity, they must first be reborn as monks for them to be eligible for enlightenment. As members of the laity perform good deeds, positive karma may bring forth a pleasant condition in the next life. In contrast, Mahayana Buddhism offers enlightenment to anyone, not only for the members of the monastic order, but also for those with families and secular careers. Moreover, the Mahayana branch of Buddhism attracts followers because it offers a faster route to enlightenment than the Theravada sect.

What's More

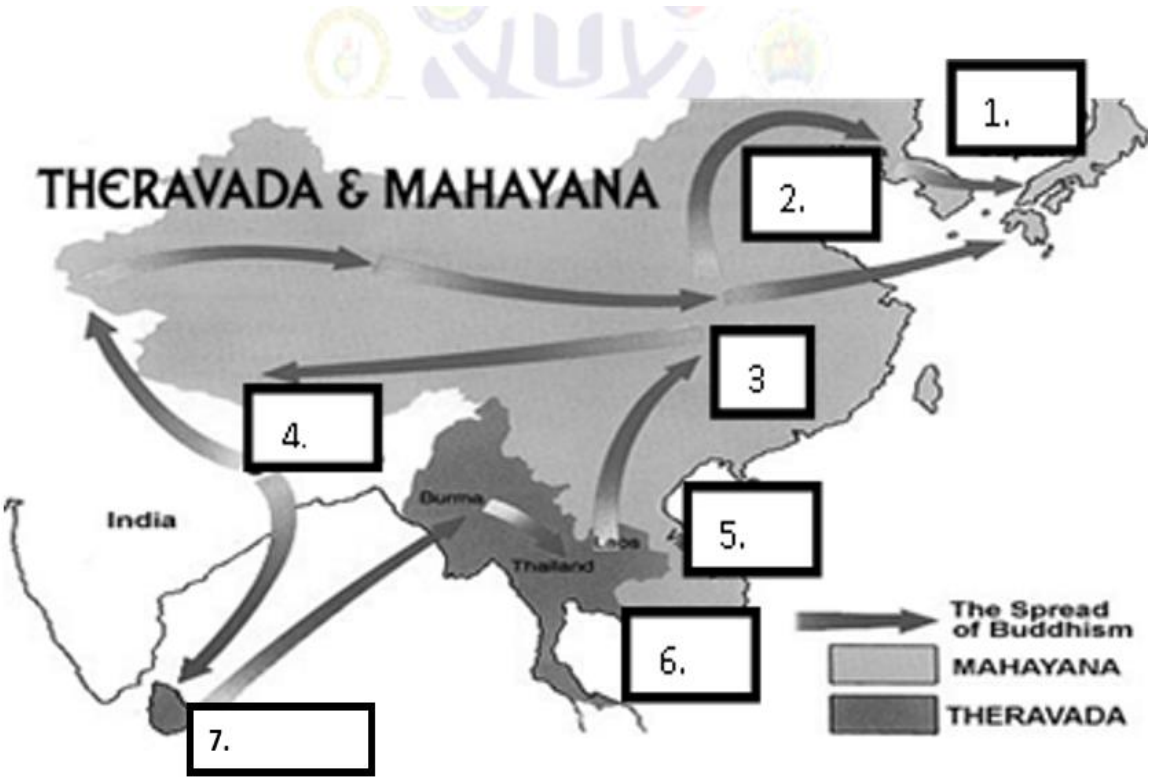
Activity 1: Let's Compare!

Directions: Make a comparison on Mahayana and Theravada by completing the table.

	Mahayana	**Theravada**
View on Siddhartha Gautama/Buddha		
Concept on Bodhisattva		
Sacred Scriptures		
Worship and observances		
Subdivisions/Sects		

Activity 2: Map it Out

Directions: Using the map identify the country where Mahayana and Theravada Buddhism flourish. Use the legend below for reference.



What I can Do

Directions: Cross out the words, concepts and phrases related to the Dharmic religions.

T	R	I	P	I	T	A	K	A	T	T	S	E	R
N	O	I	T	A	N	R	A	C	N	I	E	R	D
V	E	D	A	S	M	V	G	B	U	D	D	H	A
H	G	D	N	O	I	T	A	T	I	D	E	M	E
A	K	O	S	I	D	D	H	A	R	T	H	A	B
E	N	O	D	E	N	E	T	H	G	I	L	N	E
N	I	R	V	A	N	A	S	N	E	D	O	A	I
I	T	D	A	D	L	I	H	G	T	K	N	R	O
A	N	A	Y	A	H	A	M	D	D	A	I	B	E
O	H	L	T	A	T	T	Y	O	V	R	H	H	N
D	T	O	V	A	K	M	H	I	T	M	E	I	G
E	I	G	H	T	F	O	L	D	P	A	T	H	S
D	B	A	A	V	B	O	D	H	I	T	R	E	E
A	D	A	V	A	R	E	H	T	I	H	A	H	B

What I Need to Know

Confucianism: Religion or philosophy? Those who argue that Confucianism is a philosophy assert that when Kung Fuzi founded Confucianism, he never meant to establish a new religion; he merely wanted to interpret and revive the ancient religion of Zhou dynasty. On the other hand, Confucianism is considered a religion because its ideals were inspirational, not in the supernatural sense but in the sense of aiming for excellence in one's relationships with others. The Most Essential Learning Competency for this lesson will help the learners to analyze the brief history, core teachings, fundamental beliefs, practices, and related issues of Confucianism.

What I know

Directions: Identify the following. Choose your answer from the box.

KONGZI	ANALECTS		CLASSIC OF RITES
SEPT 28	BOOK OF POETRY		BOOK OF HISTORY
19	30'S	67	TIAN

1. Confucius is the Latinized version of _____ and the honorific Kong Fuzi both meaning "Master Kong."
2. He was born in _____ on 551 B.C.E.
3. He married at the age of _____ and had a son at the age of 20.
4. When he was in his _____ he had already started a brilliant teaching career.
5. At the age of_____, he returned home to teach (where he gained more disciples) and to preserve his classical traditions by writing and editing.

Lesson 12 Confucianism

Two symbols which are important to Confucianism are the symbols for scholar and water. The scholar, as represented by the Chinese symbol above (the *ru*), is an important symbol in Confucianism. It contains the symbol of a person, as well as the character for need or desire. The foremost need of people is nourishment, then education. When combined, it means "the need of a human being." Water is one of the five important elements in Chinese philosophy, alongside wood, fire, earth, and metal. Water is considered as the source of life, valued for its significance in the natural world and for sustaining life.

Life of Confucius

Confucius is the Latinized version of Kongzi and the honorific Kong Fuzi both meaning "Master Kong." He was born on September 28 on 551 B.C.E. Hence, it is considered a day of celebration in East Asia—an official holiday in Taiwan (Teacher's Day), and a day of cultural celebration in mainland China, Hong Kong, and Singapore. Confucius was born in a small feudal state of Lu (now Shantung province) in Qufu. His personal name was Qiu and his family name was Kong. He came from a noble family, but by the time of his birth, they had already lost much of their wealth. His first teacher was his mother, and at the age of 15 he set his heart upon learning, thus love of learning became one of the highest virtues in Confucian ethics. He married at the age of 19 and had a son at the age of 20. At this point in his life, he had already served in minor government posts and had already gained a reputation as an all-around scholar. When he was in his 30's, he had already started a brilliant teaching career because of his mastery of the arts of ritual, music, archery, charioteering, calligraphy, and arithmetic. He was also familiar with classical

tradition, particularly in poetry and history. He is often considered as the first person to devote his whole life to learning and teaching for the purpose of social transformation and improvement. He held several government positions including as arbiter, assistant minister of public works, and minister of justice in the state of Lu. For 13 years, he wandered from state to state, trying to put his theories to practice. At 67, he returned home to teach (where he gained more disciples) and to preserve his classical traditions by writing and editing. He died in 479 B.C.E at the age of 73 and he left around 3,000 followers who preserved and put his other teachings to writing.

What's New

Activity 1: The Confucian Core

Directions: Read the core teaching of Confucianism and answer the questions that follow.

The core teaching of Confucianism is how to be a "gentleman." To be a gentleman, according to Confucianism, a person should follow the moral way, consisting of the virtues of love, righteousness, wisdom, propriety, and loyalty. Becoming a gentleman promotes harmony in society.

1. As a senior high school student, write your own idea of being a gentleman.

_____
_____
_____

2. How does being a gentleman promote harmony in society? Cite an example

_____
_____
_____

Activity 2: Confucius Says…

Directions: Write two famous saying of Confucius and explain how you will apply these saying to yourself?

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

What is It

Sacred Scriptures: The Confucian Classics

The Five Classics are a group of books which was regarded as early Confucianism's basic texts. This includes the Book of Changes, the Book of History, the Book of Poetry, the Classic of Rites, and the Spring and Autumn Annals. The Analects is also considered an important source of Confucian teachings since it contains a record of his conversations with his disciples.

1. Also known as the I-Ching, the Book of Changes is believed to have existed at the time of Confucius and is the oldest of the Classics. It focuses on short predictions following a type of divination called cleromancy wherein six random numbers are picked and arranged under sixty-four hexagrams.
2. Also known as the Book of Documents or *Shangshu*, the Book of History is conventionally attributed to Confucius by early scholars. It is composed of speeches (or prose) of royalty and ministers mainly from the Shang and Zhou dynasties. It also consists of chronological accounts of imperial achievements and rules of government.
3. The Book of Poetry, also known as the Book of Songs/Odes/*Shijing*, is a collection of three hundred and five songs compiled around 600 B.C.E. which includes four sections of various themes such as love, courtship, abandonment, and dances. It also includes feast songs or state chants.
4. Originally the Three Li/Three Rites/San Li, the Classic of Rites is a compilation of ceremonial rituals, administration, and social forms of the Zhou Dynasty
5. The Analects, or *Lunyu* ("conversations" or "sayings"), is also known as the Analects of Confucius. It is a collection of sayings and ideas attributed to the Chinese philosopher Confucius and his contemporaries, traditionally believed to have been written by Confucius' followers.

What's More

Activity 1: The Golden Rule
Directions: Write the "Golden Rule" and explain its meaning in five sentences.

Activity 2: Fact Sheet

Directions: Make your own research and list down ten facts about the Confucianism.

Example: Founded by Confucius

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

What I can Do

For Confucius, family relations provide a model for social behavior. Respect for elders, whether your own or others, is emphasized, as well as kindness to your own children and juniors, including those of others. Ancestor worship is a manifestation of filial piety, or respect for one's parents, which is directed toward older relatives and ancestors.

Directions: List down at least three relationships you are involved in right now and identify the power relations in these relationships by stating if you are a subordinate, superior, or equal position in each relationship. Explain the pros and cons of the said relationships.

1. _____
   _____
2. _____
   _____
   _____

What I Need to Know

Embedded in this lesson is the Most Essential Learning Competency: analyze the brief history, core teachings, fundamental beliefs, practices, and related issues of Taoism. The learners will know more about another Daoic religion—Taoism—and understand its historical development and its relevance to Chinese society and culture. Daoism functioned as a philosophy which began in the state of Chu in the southern part of the present Hunan Province during the warring estates. The goal of Taoists was to conform to the great pattern of nature, which is called Dao, or "The Way." As a philosophy, Daoism focuses on the great mysteries of the Dao; as a religion, its goal is to achieve long life and, ultimately, immortality.

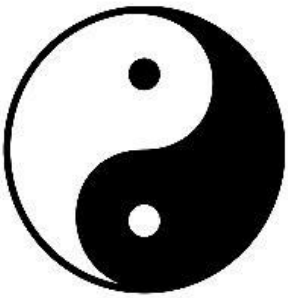
What I know

Directions: Write **TRUE** if the statement is correct, otherwise, **FALSE**.

_____ 1. The Dao is distinct from God.
_____ 2. The Dao According to Confucius, existed before the world
_____ 3. Sometimes the Dao is called "Father."
_____ 4. Dao is the origin of heaven and earth, and it is also the way in which heaven and earth now live.
_____ 5. The Dao De Jing literally means "The Book of the Way".

Lesson 13 — Taoism

The Symbol



The Yin and Yang is the most well-known Daoist religious symbol. It is an image composed of a circle divided into two swirling parts: one black and the other white. Within each swirling or teardrop-shaped half is a smaller circle of the opposite color. Overall, the Yin and Yang symbol signifies the perfect harmonic balance in the universe. For example, day and night; birth and death. According to Daoist cosmology, the big circle signifies the Tao (Dao), the source of existence. Meanwhile, the black and white teardrop-shaped halves signify the Yin-qi and Yang-qi, known as the primordial feminine and masculine energies, respectively. Taoist believe that the interplay of the Yin-qi and Yang-qi created the manifest world

Lao-Tzu

Laozi (Lao-tzu), meaning "Old Master," is believed to have authored the Dao De Jing (Tao Te Ching or The Book of the Way and its Power), dating back to around third century B.C.E. According to myth, Laozi was conceived by a shooting star and was born of a virgin mother, who kept him in her womb for 82 years; Laozi was said to be born with flowing hair, which signified that he would become a wise man. He is considered as the first important Daoist. According to Sima Qian, Laozi's family name was Li, his given name was Erh, and he was also known as Tan. According to his biography, he worked as a government archivist but became frustrated with government corruption and sensing his unavoidable disgrace he left Chu and was detained at Han-ku Pass by a gatekeeper named Yin Hsi, who requested him to write a book for him before leaving. Laozi agreeably wrote two chapters about the Dao (Way) and De (individual power), which came to be named Dao De Jing or Laozi.

What's New

Activity 1: Yin Yang

The concept of yin yang was articulated by the Daoist philosopher Zhuangzi who stated that "yin in its highest form is freezing while yang in its highest form is boiling. There are about 70 concepts of things in pair which are listed in Laozi. Write the pair of each word:

Example: increase	Decrease
1. good	
2. short	
3. bright	
4. empty	
5. strong	
6. difficult	
7. lead	
8. hot	
9. fast	
10. beautiful	

Activity 2: Lao Tzu

Directions: The image below depicts Lao Tzu. Write five information you know about him.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

What is It

Daoism

Taoism

Taoism (also spelled Daoism) is an organized religious tradition that has been developing in China, and elsewhere, for over 2,000 years. Its roots in China are believed to lie in the ancient traditions of shamans (people who were believed to have access to the spirit world). Today, Taoism has followers from a range of cultural and ethnic backgrounds.

Taoism followers aim to align with the patterns of the natural world by increasing their sensitivity to *qi* (*chi*), which they believe to be the life-force energy within all living things. Those who achieve this alignment are thought to be on a path to immortality and can gain health and happiness for themselves and others. Taoist practices include special physical movements and using breath, attention, sound and/or visualization to activate flowing energy (*qi/chi*).

Dao De Jing

Daoism's foundational text is the Tao Te Ching or Dao De Jing, meaning "The Book of the Way and its Power." The Dao De Jing has often been attributed to Laozi, but some believe that it was a product of the collective efforts among various groups in China, since a closer analysis of the scripture reveals that there is no integrated philosophy in the Dao De Jing; instead, it was a collection of sayings and proverbs, lines from popular songs, and clever maxims coming from various contributors with various concerns. The Dao De Jing, which literally means The Book of the Way and its Power, expounds on the meaning of Dao and its accompanying concept of De—the power or virtue acquired by a person by means of living in harmony with Dao.

What's More

Some religious observances:

Time of Year: March or April. This festival's purpose is: (1) celebrating the arrival of spring, and (2) honoring deceased ancestors. Families may go on outings, sing, dance or fly kites. Another popular ritual is coloring eggs, and then breaking them open to symbolize the opening of new life. Graves of ancestors are swept clean, and the plants growing around them are trimmed. Offerings such as food, tea, chopsticks, and wine are presented. Many also burn symbolic joss paper—also called "spirit money," as a way of asking for the relatives' continued guidance.

Dragon Boat Festival (Duanwu Jie)

Time of Year: May. This festival, also called "Poet's Day," honors Qu Yuan, a poet and minister to the Zhou emperor who died in despair, having failed to prevent war between feudal states in ancient China. People mark the anniversary of his death

with activities that include dragon boat races and the eating of zong zi (rice balls filled with egg, beans, fruits, walnuts, sweet potato, mushrooms and/or meat).

Dragon boats are long canoes made to look like dragons and which can be powered by up to 80 rowers. A popular festival activity—along with others believed to bring health and good luck—is creating pouches filled with herbs or spices believed to ward off disease.

Activity 1: Comparing Festivals

Directions: Compare how the Catholics and Taoists celebrate/honor the deceased ancestors/family members:

Catholics-All Soul's Day	**Daoists-Tomb Sweeping Day**
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

Dao

The Dao According to Laozi, the Dao, which is the essential concept and creative principle in Daoism, existed before the world. It is undetectable, indistinct, shapeless, and indefinable, it is the foundation of all being, and the way in which nature and the universe exist. All things come from it, and are nourished by it, that is why sometimes the Dao is called "Mother." Dao is the origin of heaven and earth, and it is also the way in which heaven and earth now live. The Dao is distinct from God. It is not a being for it is the origin of all beings, and its great virtue is that it does everything but desires nothing. It is "emptiness", which does not compete with other forces but is content with itself.

Activity 2: Illustrate it!
Directions: Make your own depiction of the Dao by drawing it in the box.

What I can Do

Filipino Superstitious Beliefs

Another issue encountered by Daoism is the belief in superstitious practices. For instance, there is a misconception that Daoism involves sorcery, which includes the drawing of signs, chants, and other practices which led to the notion that Daoism promotes superstitious practices.

Directions: Write ten (10) Filipino superstitious that you believe in. Give explanation for each belief.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

What I Need to Know

Shintoism is considered as the very essence of Japanese devotion to unseen spiritual beings and powers. It is a very local kind of religion in that it is focused on the land of Japan, hence an "ethnic religion" that is not interested in missionary activities to spread it outside Japan. Shintoism espouses the belief that "human beings are basically good and has no concept of original sin."

The Most Essential Learning Competency for this lesson is to examine the brief history, core teachings, fundamental beliefs, practices, and related issues of Shintoism.

What I know

Directions: Identify the following:

1. It is the most common symbol for Shintoism_____
2. It narrates that in the beginning there were two kami, Izanagi-no-Mikoto (male) and Izanamino-Mikoto (female)_____
3. The goddess of the sun_____
4. It narrates the following account of the creation of the three great kami_____
5. The first emperor of Japan_____

Lesson 14	Shintoism

Origin

The Torii Gate is the most common symbol for Shintoism. It is a sacred gateway supposed to represent a gate upon which a cock crew on the occasion when Amaterasu emerged from the rock cave and relighted the world. It marks the entrance to a sacred space which is the Shinto shrine. It represents the transition between the world of humans and the world of the gods and goddesses. It is believed to help prepare the visitor for their interaction with the spirits by signifying the sacredness of the location. It is traditionally made of wood or stone, but now most toriis are made of concrete and steel.

Sacred Scriptures

The *Kojiki* and *Nihongi* are considered as sacred scriptures on Shinto, although they are not exclusively about Shinto; they also contain extensive information on Buddhism and Confucianism. These books, which are compilations of ancient myths and traditional teachings, are considered to have a dual purpose: a political as well as a moral purpose. Its political purpose is to establish the supremacy of Japan over all countries in the world by legitimizing the divine authority of the ruling families and to establish the political supremacy of the Yamato. Its moral purpose is to explain the relationship between the kami and human beings by establishing that the Japanese are a special people chosen by the kami, who have many humanlike characteristics. It also emphasizes purification as both a creative and cleansing act. Death is considered as the ultimate impurity.

What's New

The development of Shintoism in Japan has a long history. During the prehistoric period in Japan, animism was evident in the agricultural affairs of the people. Agricultural rites were celebrated seasonally, and all communal religious activities were focused on objects or places believed to be inhabited by kami or spirits. Later, adherents formulated rituals and stories for them to make sense of their universe, such as creation stories regarding Japan and its natural elements, thereby creating their own sense of cultural and spiritual worlds.

One such story is the "Story of Creation," which narrates that in the beginning there were two kami, Izanagi-no-Mikoto (male) and Izanamino-Mikoto (female).

According to the myth, Amaterasu-o-mi-kami, the goddess of the sun, came out of Izanagi's left eye while Tsukiyomi-no-Mikoto came out of his right eye, and Susa-no-Wo-no-Mikoto came from his nostrils.

The Nihongi narrates the following account of the creation of the three great kami of the upper air: Amaterasu-Omikami, who is believed to have come from the left eye of the sky god Izanagi, is considered the sun goddess and the ancestor of the

Japanese imperial family, with Emperor Jimmu Tenno, Amaterasu's great grandson, as the first emperor of Japan.

Activity 1: The Story of Creation

Directions: In a separate sheet of paper, narrate the "The Story of Creation". Follow the rubrics for the narrative report.

Standard	5	4	3
Organization	Well-narrated	The order of events needs to be corrected	The narrative needs to be organized
Ideas/Content	Rich in details	Some details are missing	Needs more details
Characters	All characters are included	Few characters are included	Less than 4 characters are included
Total			

What is It

There are various ways by which Shintoists worship *kami*. They may worship at home, at Shinto shrines, and during seasonal festivals. At Home (kamidana) Shintoists often place a small altar ("kami shelf") inside their houses and this is where they perform the following rituals: purification; offertory; clapping their hands to the kami; and offering of prayers.

At Shinto Shrine also called ceremonial worship, this includes a visit to a Shinto shrine which detaches a worshipper from his or her ordinary environment. In this type of worship, trees in Shinto shrines, have ropes tied to them to signify reverence to the presence of kami.

Aside from worshipping the kami at the shrines, one of the main attractions at the shrines is the sale and distribution of charms or amulets. Shintoists believe that these amulets provide protection and can even be a source of magic. They often carry personal amulets, and their homes are guarded by magical charms in the form of lintel placards or different talismanic symbols placed on the altars for their deities. The most common Japanese designation for charm is *mamori*, which they believe provides them with protection and may include a wide range of objects.

Shrine Visits of Prime Ministers

Shrine visits refer to visits being made by important Japanese such as Prime Ministers to Shinto shrines. This is being done to show respect to people who died in the service of the emperor. One example of such a shrine is the Yasukuni Shrine, in

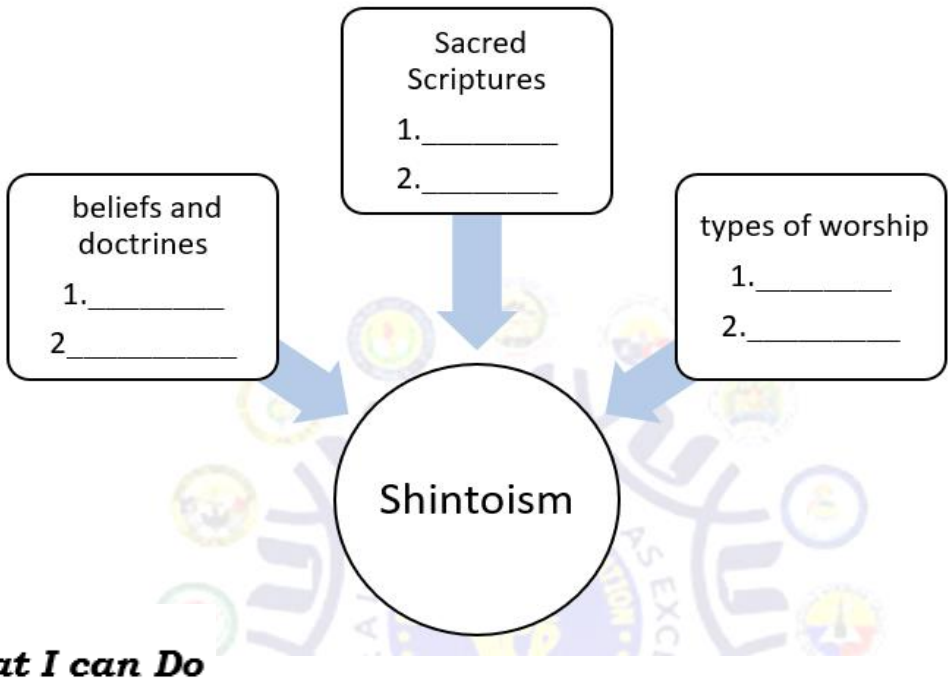
the Chiyoda ward in Tokyo, which houses the remains of soldiers as well as civilians who produced war materials, who all died in the service of the Emperor Meiji.

What's More

Directions: Identify the following by rearranging the jumbled words,

1. It is one of the most important texts on Shintoism_____ KIJIKO
2. It houses the remains of soldiers as well as civilians, who all died in the service of the Emperor Meiji. MIKUUSYA NIRHSE
3. It narrates the mythology_____ GAE FO IKAM
4. Agricultural rites were celebrated seasonally, and all communal religious activities were focused on objects or places believed to be inhabited by kami or _____SPITISR
5. It narrates that in the beginning there were two kami, Izanagi-no-Mikoto (male) and Izanamino-Mikoto (female)_____ SROTY OF CRATIONE
6. The most common Japanese designation for charm _____MAOMRI
7. It records the descent of the Yamato rulers of Japan from the gods. NIIHONG
8. It refers to visits being made by important Japanese such as Prime Ministers to Shinto shrines_____ SHNERI VITIS
9. This is where Shintoists perform rituals_____. KADANAMI
10. It is the most common symbol for Shintoism. TOIIR GTEA

Activity 2: Complete the following:



What I can Do

Directions: The Japanese people have always been seen as very nationalistic, and this has always been attributed to the myths provided by Shintoism, such as tracing back their ancestry to the deities, particularly Amaterasu. Write five ways you, as a senior high student, can be nationalistic.

1. _____

2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

What I Need to Know

The three Daoic religions—Confucianism, Daoism, and Shintoism—all originated from East Asia, thus they are also called East Asian religions. Confucianism and Daoism both came from China during the Warring States Period (Zhou dynasty) while Shintoism, which is also regarded as an "indigenous religion," thus it is hard to trace its origins, came from Japan.

The Most Essential Learning Competency (MELC) is to explain the uniqueness and similarities of Confucianism, Taoism and Shintoism.

What I know

Directions: Write **TRUE** if the statement is correct, otherwise, **FALSE**.

_____ 1. Daoism was also meant to offer solutions to China's social upheavals.
_____ 2. Kung Fu Tzi who is considered as Daoism's prominent philosopher, authored Daoism's sacred scripture, the Dao De Jing.
_____ 3. Shintoism originated in Korea.
_____ 4. In Confucianism, the concept of morality is based on loyalty.
_____ 5. Daoism believes that society should not be regulated with morality.

Lesson 15 — Comparative Analysis of Confucianism, Daoism, & Shintoism

Origin

Confucianism may have started during the time of Kung Fuzi, but his ideas became popular only after his death, with the initiatives of Mengzi, and later of Xunzi, who were among those who contributed their own ideas to Confucianism on concepts such as human nature, morality, politics, and government. It initially started as a philosophy that would provide a solution to China's chaotic society during the Zhou dynasty, but later it became a religion as well, although its main contribution to China lies in its ethical and moral dimensions.

Daoism also started in China at almost the same period when Confucianism developed. It was also meant to offer solutions to China's social upheavals during the time. Laozi, who is considered as Daoism's prominent philosopher, authored Daoism's sacred scripture, the Dao De Jing. Daoism believed that nature should be allowed to take its natural course for the attainment of social order.

Shintoism originated in Japan. It is considered an animistic folk religion and its origin is hard to trace, but it started as an indigenous religion with utmost

importance given to spirits (or kami) in nature. Later it was used by the imperial family to legitimize their rule and it was even declared as a state religion for a long time. It emphasized the core values of family, tradition, nature, ancestors, purity, and ritual practices.

Morality

In Confucianism, the concept of morality is based on loyalty to one's superiors and elders, parents, and respect for others. Loyalty is also translated as "regard for others" (zhong), specifically loyalty to one's superior but also includes respect to one's equals and subordinates. The importance of self-reflection is also emphasized, with the Golden Rule as the guiding principle, "Do not do unto others what you do not want others do unto you."

Daoism believes that society should not be regulated with morality but should be allowed to exist according to the natural laws. It also advocated the idea that one should perform good deeds that would be known only to the gods. Included in the guidelines were the prohibition on stealing, adultery, abortion, murder, intoxication, and overindulgence.

Shinto morality is not based on definite standards of right and wrong. Since Shintoism is focused on following the will of the kami or spirits, anything that is not in accordance with the will of the kami is considered bad. Shintoism has provided the Japanese with a way of life that revolves around the worship of the kami, while Confucianism from China provided them with ethics. Hence, Shinto morality is based on having purity not only in the physical sense but also in a spiritual and moral sense.

What's New

Purpose

Confucianism advocates the idea that the goal of everyone should be to reach one's highest potential as a person, and this can be achieved through self-cultivation. To become virtuous, one should be mindful of all the senses (sight, hearing, speech, and action) and make sure that every action, thought, and feeling should be in accordance with li (ritual).

In Daoism, the purpose of existence is to ensure that order and harmony are maintained by being aligned with nature. Self-cultivation is also needed because it is the only way to return to the natural state of existence. The goal of every person is to make the body capable of reacting in a natural and spontaneous way. Doing physical exercises may help the body achieve that goal. Since spontaneity is meant only for the immortals, common people should instead aim for a long and healthy life. Activities such as gymnastics, breathing exercises, dietary restrictions, drinking talisman water, and certain sexual practices can help achieve longevity and well-being.

Shintoism emphasized the importance of purification rituals to maintain the natural state of existence. Avoidance of pollution or anything that they consider impure (death, blood, or disease) is seen to maintain purity. In Shintoism, maintaining the pure and natural state of existence is the purpose of life, and one should start with oneself.

What is It

Religion/Belief	Characteristics
Confucianism	Reality has two spheres: the inner sphere and the outer sphere. Destiny (or ming) is considered the outer reality which is outside the control and concern of people. Self-cultivation should be the goal of everyone
Daoism	"non-doing" or "non-action." "non-action" does not mean not taking any action at all. Instead, self-cultivation is also needed so that one may develop oneself to the extent that one's actions are naturally in accordance with the flow of the universe. Destiny or fate can only be achieved when one has cultivated oneself to the highest potential that one's actions go effortlessly with the way of the universe.
Shintoism	Advocates the idea that every person has a destiny to follow, a mission to fulfill which will make one's life worthwhile. Shintoism believes that humanity's natural greatness can only be achieved by returning oneself to the state of natural purity.

What's More

A. Directions: Encircle the words, names and ideas related to the three Daoic religions.

M	O	M	V	T	H	E	W	A	Y	A	I	S	G
E	L	H	U	C	I	S	T	C	E	L	A	N	A
M	O	C	N	G	Z	U	O	T	I	V	S	I	S
Y	N	C	N	Z	G	I	E	O	I	W	C	D	H
T	W	E	C	N	N	C	E	R	C	S	I	A	I
I	T	I	M	K	A	N	S	I	U	C	S	O	N
D	N	I	O	I	U	E	O	I	N	G	S	T	T
A	M	L	W	W	H	M	C	G	N	A	A	E	O
O	I	S	A	S	Z	U	M	A	N	M	L	C	I
I	E	A	U	O	F	W	Y	T	A	S	C	H	S
S	W	A	T	N	T	N	A	E	I	I	E	I	M
M	U	L	O	C	I	Z	N	C	F	O	V	N	N
M	W	C	G	Y	I	A	U	T	O	A	I	G	H
F	L	F	S	I	Y	K	A	M	I	T	F	H	H

B. Directions: Classify the following. Write **C** for Confucianism, **T** for Taoism and **S** for Shintoism.

1. Shrine Visit
2. Kami Worship
3. Magical Charms and Amulets
4. Dao Te Ching
5. Yin Yang
6. Wu-Wei
7. Laozi
8. The Way
9. Five Classics
10. Filial Piety

What I can Do

Comparing the Dao

Directions: Compare the three Daoic religions by completing the table below.

Religion	Symbols	Believer	Sacred Text	Relevant Figures
Confucianism				
Daoism				
Shintoism				

Assessment

Directions: Identify the following. Write **C** for Confucianism, **T** for Taoism or **S** for Shintoism.

_____ 1. The goal of a person can be achieved through self-cultivation.
_____ 2. To become virtuous, one should be mindful of all the senses.
_____ 3. The purpose of existence is to ensure that order and harmony are maintained by being aligned with nature.
_____ 4. Believes that society should not be regulated with morality.
_____ 5. Activities such as gymnastics, breathing exercises, etc, can help achieve longevity and well-being.
_____ 6. Emphasized the importance of purification rituals to maintain the natural state of existence.
_____ 7. Avoidance of pollution or anything that they consider impure
_____ 8. Reality has two spheres: the inner sphere and the outer sphere.
_____ 9. "non-doing" or "non-action."
_____ 10. Destiny or fate can only be achieved when one has cultivated oneself to the highest potential that one's actions go effortlessly with the way of the universe.

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